

Request for Information 70RWMD26RFIP00006 Working Animal Readiness and Response Training

Department of Homeland Security | Office of Health Security |

* Required

Instructions

To assist OHS understand your company's capability, please provide detailed responses to the questions below, tailored to the DHS Working Animal Readiness and Response (WARR) Training needs described in the RFI and draft Performance Work Statement. DHS recognizes that this is an RFI and that vendors are **not reimbursed** for the time and resources required to respond. To help balance burden and usefulness:

- You **do not need to answer** every question
- Please **prioritize the** questions that best showcase your core capabilities and/or where you believe additional clarity from DHS would be most helpful.
- For any question you choose not to answer, you may leave it blank or indicate "Not Addressed."
- If a question clearly does not apply to your service(s), please state "**Not Applicable (N/A)**" and briefly explain why.

Section 1 – Corporate Overview

1. Legal Business Name *

2. Company Website *

3. Point of Contact's Name, E-mail, and Phone Number *

4. Provide the associated NAICS code under which this company conducts business.

5. Is this company registered in the System for Award Management (SAM)? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

6. If you answer Yes to Question 4, provide the company's Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) Number

7. **Company Profile** Indicate the Business Size (Large or Small) and Socio-Economic Status for this company. *

- ☐ Small Business
- ☐ Small Disadvantaged Business
- ☐ HUBZone Business
- ☐ Service Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business
- ☐ Veteran Owned Small Business
- ☐ Woman-Owned Small Business
- ☐ Large Business
- ☐ Other

Overall Capability and Relevant Experience

8. **Overall Capability and Relevant Experience.** Describe your organization's history and experience providing **working animal medical training** (canine and/or equine), including:

- Types of courses offered (e.g., working dog first aid, advanced canine trauma care, equine emergency first aid, wilderness equine care, or similar training).
- Primary target audiences (e.g., law enforcement canine handlers, equine riders, EMS personnel, veterinary professionals, or other operational personnel).
- Typical training settings (e.g., on-site at client locations, training centers, field environments, or mobile delivery platforms).
- Years in business
- Headquarters location
- Number of employees

Please enter at most 2000 characters

9. **Overall Capability and Relevant Experience.** Indicate whether you have performed work of **similar scale and complexity** to the anticipated WARR Training requirement, such as:

- ☐ Delivering tens to hundreds of courses annually across multiple regions or nationwide.
- ☐ Supporting clients with law enforcement, border security, aviation/transportation security, maritime, or other high-risk operational missions.
- ☐ Experience supporting federal and state, or local government customers with comparable operational requirements.
- ☐ No

10. **Overall Capability and Relevant Experience.** If you answered No to Question #8 because you have not performed work at this scale, identify the largest training program you have supported, including:

- Approximate **number of courses and students** per year.
- Geographic spread (national, regional, local; urban/rural).

Please enter at most 2000 characters

11. **Relevant Experience** Provide at least three (3) references and no more than five (5) for implementations of similar scope and complexity (federal references preferred). Include organization name, contact information, project scope, and implementation timeframe.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Domain Expertise: Canine, Equine, EMS Intergration

12. Canine Domain.

- Describe your organization's expertise in **working canine medicine, first aid, and advanced aid.**
- Identify any **veterinary specialists** or SMEs (e.g., canine emergency/critical care) – and their relevant credentials – who support your curriculum.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

13. Equine Domain.

- Describe your organization's expertise in equine emergency and field care, particularly in outdoor, mounted patrol, austere, or wilderness settings.
- Identify any equine veterinary specialists or SMEs supporting your equine curriculum.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

14. EMS / prehospital integration.

- Describe your experience training EMS clinicians (e.g., EMTs, Advanced EMTs, Paramedics) to apply their human medical skills to working animals in the field.
- Indicate whether your staff or SMEs include personnel with current or prior EMS clinician credentials (e.g., EMT, Paramedic) and how this expertise is integrated into training.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

15. Indicate whether you can support:

- ☐ Canine training only
- ☐ Equine training only
- ☐ Both canine and equine training

16. If you responded to Question #14, that indicated that you can support only one domain, describe how you would propose teaming or subcontracting to deliver the other.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Curriculum Development, Standards, and Accreditation

17. Describe your approach to **curriculum development and maintenance** for working animal first aid and advanced aid, including:

- Use of **evidence-based veterinary guidelines** and alignment with recognized frameworks (e.g., canine TCCC / cTECC, equine emergency care standards).
- Processes for updating curricula in response to **emerging threats**, new evidence, or client requirements.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

18. Discuss any **accreditations, recognitions, or partnerships** relevant to your training (e.g., CAPCE, NAEMT, veterinary specialty organizations), if applicable.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

19. Explain how your curricula could be tailored to:

- DHS canine handlers and equine riders operating in **high-risk / austere environments**.
- EMS providers integrating animal care into broader **prehospital response**.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Training Delivery Model and Geographic Coverage

20. Describe your **training delivery model**, including:

- In-person, hybrid, and/or online course formats.
- Typical course length and structure (lecture, hands-on skill stations, scenarios).
- Use of **live animals, mannequins/simulators, or other training aids**.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

21. Discuss your ability to deliver training **nationwide within CONUS**, including:

- Regions and types of locations currently support (e.g., border regions, maritime, airports).
- Experience providing mobile or on-site training at government or operational locations

Please enter at most 2000 characters

22. Based on the planning assumptions (on the order of **40–50 canine courses per year** and **up to 10 equine courses per year**):

- Describe your **capacity** to support this level of effort annually.
- Describe how you would plan for **surge** or fluctuating demand across DHS Components

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Instructors, Key Personnel, and Staffing Model

23. Describe your typical **staffing model** for programs like WARR, including:

- Program/Contract Manager or similar role.
- Lead Veterinary Instructors (canine and/or equine).
- Additional instructors, veterinary technicians, EMS SMEs, and support staff.

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24. For your instructors and key personnel, identify:

- Minimum qualifications (e.g., DVM, years of experience in working animal medicine, field operations experience, adult education/training credentials).
- Any relevant EMS or prehospital experience/credentials that would support alignment with DHS EMS practices.
- Instructor-to student ratios typically used for similar training

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25. Explain how you ensure **continuity**, coverage, and quality when key instructors are unavailable (e.g., cross-training, bench strength).

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Training Logistics, Safety, and Risk Management

26. Describe your experience managing **logistics** for mobile training, including:

- Registration, rosters, certificates, and student communications.
- Securing appropriate training venues (indoor/outdoor; canine and equine-appropriate facilities).
- Provision of training equipment, mannequins/simulators, and non-pharmaceutical supplies

Please enter at most 2000 characters

27. Describe your **safety and risk management approach**, including:

- Protocols for participant and animal safety during hands-on training.
- Emergency procedures for human and animal incidents during courses.
- Compliance with applicable animal welfare standards and regulations during live-animal demonstrations, if used.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Assessment, Certification, and Performance Reporting

28. Explain how you conduct **skills assessments** and knowledge checks, including:

- Methods for pre- and post-training assessments.
- Use of scenario-based evaluations.
- Criteria for successful completion and certification

Please enter at most 2000 characters

29. Describe your **reporting capabilities**, including:

- Course-level documentation (rosters, assessment summaries, AARs).
- Aggregated performance and utilization reporting (e.g., quarterly summaries).
- Ability to provide data needed for Government performance monitoring (e.g., learning gains, participation by Component)

Please enter at most 2000 characters

IT / LMS and Records Management (if applicable)

30. If you provide or use a **Learning Management System (LMS)** or training portal:

- Describe its features (registration, course completion tracking, certificates, reporting).
- Describe role-based access and security controls.
- Indicate whether it has been used for **federal law enforcement or similar clients**.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

31. Describe how you would support **training records management** and data sharing with DHS (e.g., export formats, secure transmission).

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Contract Structure and Pricing Considerations

32. Based on your experience, provide recommendations on:

- How contract line items (CLINs) or task areas might be structured (e.g., separate CLINs for canine vs. equine training; separate CLIN for project management/QA).
- Appropriate pricing models under a firm-fixed-price construct (e.g., annual FFP by domain, per-course pricing, per-seat pricing with a fixed annual cap).

Please enter at most 2000 characters

33. Discuss any **risks, constraints, or assumptions** that would affect your ability to price and perform WARR Training at the anticipated scale (e.g., travel costs, venue constraints, live-animal availability).

Please enter at most 2000 characters

Teaming, Subcontracting, and Small Business Participation

34. If you are a large business, describe how you would incorporate **small businesses and socio-economic partners** into your delivery (e.g., specialized canine/equine trainers, regional partners, logistics providers).

Please enter at most 2000 characters

35. If you are a small business, indicate:

- Whether you would propose as a **prime** or as a **subcontractor/teaming partner**.
- Any existing partnerships or **mentor-protégé relationships** that would enhance your capability to deliver at this scale.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

36. Describe how you would manage **teaming/subcontracting relationships** to ensure consistent curriculum, quality, and performance across multiple vendors.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

37. **Contract Vehicles and Procurement Approach** Identify federal contract vehicles through which your services are currently available (e.g., GSA MAS, agency BPAs). For each, provide contract number and relevant SINS or task areas.

Please enter at most 2000 characters

38. **Contract Vehicles and Procurement Approach**
If your services are not currently on a government-wide vehicle, what acquisition approach would you recommend (e.g., agency-specific IDIQ, BPA)?

Please enter at most 2000 characters

39. **Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM) Estimates** If readily available, provide a non-binding ROM, provide a rough order of magnitude (ROM) estimate for WARR Training. This ROM is not binding, but should be realistic enough to inform DHS budget planning.

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